

Juz Amma
(~114)

Tafsir of Juz Amma #1

Surah Fil - Surah Nas

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Miftaah Seekers Fall 2025-26

Link to other docs

[Tafsir of Juz Amma \(Sheikh Abdullah\)](#)

[Tafsir of Juz Amma \(MAW #2\)](#)

The Goal of the Quran: To Fall in Love with It

Goal: The goal of the Quran is not just to be amazed by it, but to fall in love with it.

Example of the people of Abu Jahal: They used to linger in alleyways to hear the Prophet (peace be upon him) reciting during tahajjud, not out of love, but out of sheer amazement. They marveled at the recitation, but lacked genuine love for the message.

Quranic verse:

"وَلَا تُمَدِّنْ عَيْنَيْكَ إِلَىٰ مَا مَتَّعْنَا بِهِ أَزْوَاجًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا تَحْزَنْ" (Quran 15:88)

"Do not extend your glances toward what We have given to some people and do not grieve."

This verse teaches us contentment, reminding us that the gifts of this world are transient, and we should focus on the eternal gift – the Quran and Islam

Happiness: Only once in the Quran does Allah command people to be happy. We are not taught to pursue happiness as a goal but to seek contentment.

Contentment: True happiness should come only when reflecting on the Quran and being Muslim, as taught in the Quran.

Morning Affirmation:

"رَضِيتُ بِاللَّهِ رَبًّا"

"I am content with Allah as my Lord." – This is a daily reminder to love Allah and seek contentment in His blessings.

Falling in love with the Quran requires: Learning, reading, and putting in effort. The process of learning and interacting with the Quran is what fosters a deep connection.

Knowledge: Knowledge does not always need to be entertaining. It needs to be supportive and beneficial.

Surah Taha

In Surah Taha, the Prophet (peace be upon him) is asked, *"Did a new story of Musa come your way?"*

The lesson here is that your attentiveness to the Quran should not be based on whether the story is new but on what new lessons can be derived from it. Every moment in the Quran offers new lessons to be learned.

Imam Ahmed and Imam Shafi'i:

Imam Ahmed's Praise for Imam Shafi'i:

Imam Ahmed was known to highly praise Imam Shafi'i. His admiration was so great that it seemed Imam Shafi'i was almost flawless in his eyes.

Imam Shafi'i as Observed by His Wife:

Imam Shafi'i's wife once remarked that Imam Shafi'i didn't seem as special as Imam Ahmed had described. She gave three reasons for her observation:

He ate all the food presented to him.

He was pious but never asked for water during tahajjud.

He woke up for fajr but never made wudhu, as he was already in a state of wudhu.

Imam Ahmed's Response:

Imam Shafi'i was the epitome of dedication and sincerity in his worship, even though his actions seemed simple. Imam Ahmed responded by sharing his deep admiration for Imam Shafi'i's scholarly ability, his humility, and his understanding of the deen. The lessons from Imam Shafi'i were not just in his actions but also in the profound depth of his understanding.

Lessons Learned from Imam Shafi'i's Behavior:

Be grateful for halal sustenance.

Do not waste food and eat it when it is warm.

Seek lessons in every moment of life, even if it means staying up all night contemplating a hadith.

The Story of Imam Shafi'i and the Hadith:

Once, Imam Shafi'i was so immersed in a hadith that he stayed up the whole night extracting 70 lessons from it, to the point where he could not pray tahajjud. The hadith was about the Prophet (peace be upon him) comforting a young boy who was grieving the loss of his pet bird.

This story exemplified emotional intelligence and the importance of compassion.

"Oh Umayr, what happened to your bird?" – A simple, yet effective way of comforting someone.

Lessons from this Hadith:

It's permissible to nickname children

It's permissible to name animals.

It's permissible to comfort people over the death of animals.

It's permissible to bring animals to the masjid.

The Quran's Process of Revelation:

The Quran was revealed over 23 years.

Why 23 years?

The gradual revelation helped people naturally progress into the deen, accommodating their growth and struggles.

Purpose:

To serve as a mechanism of consoling the Prophet (peace be upon him).
It is not just a book of prophecies, but rather a manual for life.

The Sequence of the Quran (Nadm):

The sequence of the Quran is crucial. Each Ayah connects to the other, and every Surah complements the next.

Surah Duha and Surah Inshirah are considered "sibling surahs" because they share themes and are complementary.

Some scholars dedicate their entire lives to studying the sequence (Nadm) of the Quran. **Abdullah Ibn Mas'ud** used to recite Surah Al-Fil in a pair, emphasizing how certain Surahs are meant to be recited together.

105 | Surah Al Fil

105 | Surah Al Fil

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 105

Order of Revelation: 19

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Protection of the Ka'bah
- Allah's Might

Background and Introduction

- **Safety** and **sustenance** are key components for a thriving community.
- Many people flee their homes due to a lack of safety or economic hardship.
- Surah Al-Fil and Surah Quraish are both responses to Prophet Ibrahim's (AS) dua for safety and sustenance in Mecca.
- **Imaan comes from Aman (أَمَان):** True faith is rooted in safety, which protects believers from the punishment of Jahannam.

Historical Background

- Yemen has always been a hub of belief (in this case for the Christians). Abraha, originally a Christian Abyssinian leader, tried to draw the economy to Yemen by building a false Kaaba (after seeing the economic benefits). It was unsuccessful; people continued to hold the true Kaaba in high regard.
- **The Destruction of the False Kaaba:** Some Meccans defecated in and set fire to the false Kaaba, leading to its destruction. This provoked Abraha.
- **Taif and Mecca Rivalry:** were the two major cities in the region, like New York and LA today. People used to think that if the Prophet (peace be upon him) came from a big city, his prophethood would be more credible.
- **Taif's support of Abraha:** seeing Mecca as a competition, the people of Taif cooperated with Abraha. However Abraha, being a Christian, rejected idolatry and actually **destroyed their idols**, Laat and Uzza. Mufti makes note that while Abraha made the wrong decision trying to attack the Kaaba, he was a **Hanif** (believing in one god).
- **Lion and the Goats:** Mufti compares Abraha's betrayal of the people of Taif after receiving their help to an allegory in which a lion eats goats one by one. Each time it

comes to a pack of goats, it says it will leave them alone if they just hand over the weakest goat. This happens until only the strongest goat is left. The strongest goat, thinking it would be spared, realizes too late that its own death was imminent for allowing the weaker goats to be taken first.

- The story teaches a lesson of how failing to protect the weak members of a community out of self preservation is futile. Such was the example of the people of Taif who collaborated with Abraha foolishly.
- **Abdul Motalib's Story:** Abdul Motalib, the Prophet's grandfather, approached Abu Raha with a plea. Abraha had captured all his sheep and goats while setting base on his land. Abraha, recognizing Abdul Motalib's honorable reputation and commanding presence, actually stood up from his seat to greet him. Abdul Motalib, contrary to Abraha's expectations, did not ask for anything related to the safety of the Kaaba and merely asked for his goats back.
- Abdul Motalib, in a famous narration, responded: "I am the master of these animals, but Allah owns the Kaaba, and He will protect it."
- This reflects **azzam** (deep commitment): Abdul Motalib showed a commitment that transcended personal interests in regards to taking care of what Allah had trusted him with. And when it came to matters out of his hands he fully trusted Allah.

Abraha and the Elephant Army

- This surah is named after the elephants in Abraha's army.
- Under the most impossible of circumstances, Allah kept the dua of Ibrahim answered by keeping the city safe by destroying Abraha and his army.
- This event was so significant that the Arabs used it to mark the entire year, calling it The Year of the Elephant.

Context of the Kaaba's Sacred Protection

- The dua of Prophet Ibrahim (AS) was so powerful that even the Dajjal cannot enter Mecca. The dua of Prophet Ibrahim (2:128):

"Our Lord! And make us submissive unto You and of our offspring a nation submissive unto You, and show us our Manasik (all the ceremonies of pilgrimage - Hajj and 'Umrah, etc.), and accept our repentance. Truly, You are the One Who accepts repentance, the Most Merciful.

Protection in Mecca:

- A person cannot be killed in the Haram (sacred area).
- Even animals and grass are protected.
- Allah's power and mercy ensure that Mecca is a sanctified, safe place.

Surah Al-Fil demonstrates

1. **Sacred Protection:** the Kaaba is divinely protected.
2. **Allah does not need humans** to protect His sanctuaries.
3. **Dua:** that Allah does not miss any dua and can fulfill them generations later. Mufti makes mention that parent's dua may not always reach their child but it can reach their grandchildren, just as how Ibrahim AS dua carried over many generations later.
4. Never Say "Despite" When Talking About Blessings. When you say "despite," you undermine the role of Allah. Instead, always attribute blessings to Allah's will, saying "because of" the deen.

Ayah Breakdown

Ayah 1: "أَلَمْ تَرَ كَيْفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ بِأَصْحَابِ الْفِيلِ"

"Have you not considered how your Lord dealt with the companions of the elephant?"

- **Alamtara** (أَلَمْ تَرَ): The word *tara* refers to the act of seeing, but it carries both a physical and figurative meaning. It suggests more than just physical sight – it's understanding or considering something based on knowledge, even if you haven't directly observed it yourself. Therefore, *considered* is an appropriate translation, implying awareness of the event. This could be interpreted as directed to either the Prophet or the Quraish, Allah could be talking to either party.
- **Ashab ul-Fil:** The army of elephants: Mecca had never seen elephants; they were exotic and symbolic of a great force. 9-13 elephants, the best one's name was **Mahmood**.
- Fil - Elephant (singular form). Allah used the singular form even though there were between 9 to 13 elephants in the army.
- This is because the army was known by its largest elephant, known as Mahmood
- is also a singular word which can refer to an entire category [Ism Jam']
- The humans were below the elephants in status. The elephants stopped moving, while the humans were unable to proceed, showing Allah's control over nature
- **Contextual Interpretation:** This ayah could be directed either to the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) or to the Quraysh. Both groups would reflect on the event of the army of the elephant, either to strengthen the Prophet's trust in Allah or to remind the Quraysh of Allah's power and His protection of the Kaaba.
- **Fa'ala** (فَعَلَ): The verb *fa'ala* (did it) is not an intense declaration like "conquered" or "destroyed" but rather a mild expression of action. It suggests that the army, despite its strength, was defeated effortlessly by Allah's command. It implies that this supposed mighty force was insignificant in the face of Allah's will.

Message of this ayah: dealing with people plotting against allah is lightwork for him. Trust allah and know better than to doubt his protection over things that are divine

Ayah 2: "أَلَمْ يَجْعَلْ كَيْدَهُمْ فِي تَضْلِيلٍ"

"Did He not make their plan into misguidance?"

- **Ja'ala** - means to take something and transform it into something else. Yaj'al - is present tense form. Allah uses "yaj'al" to show that while he allowed them to make their plan and execute it, he was also capable of immediately transforming it into waste.
- **Kayda**: There are lots of words in arabic that can be used to say "plan". Allah uses **kayda** which means "secret plan"
- **Tadleel** (تَضْلِيلٍ) - means to waste or destroy
- Despite the army's attempt to destroy the Kaaba, Allah turned their schemes into confusion and misguidance. This highlights that, even if they were aligned against Allah and the truth, their plans were ultimately futile.
- The verse speaks to the power of Allah to turn the most carefully laid plans into utter failure when they are against His will.
- Abrahams failures:
 - Trying to bring economy to Yemen: the fake Kaaba was mocked and destroyed.
 - Failing to eliminate competition by trying to draw away peoples love of Mecca: unable to make Arabs love it like the Ka'bah
 - Disrespecting divinity by trying to attack the Kaaba.
 - Yajjaal (transform) is how Allah transformed all of his plans

Message of this ayah: doesn't matter how secretive or well thought out a plan is, Allah is capable of turning things upside down in the blink of an eye.

Ayah 3: "وَأَرْسَلَ عَلَيْهِمْ طَيْرًا أَبَابِيلَ"

"And He sent against them birds in flocks"

- **Tayran** (طَيْرًا): The word *tayran* refers to birds in general, a group of birds, not necessarily a specific or special type. They were ordinary birds, highlighting that Allah can use even the simplest and most humble of creations to carry out His will, demonstrating His absolute control over all things.
- **Ababeel** (أَبَابِيلَ): This term refers to birds that come in rows, formations, or flocks. It gives the impression of an organized group, carrying out a precise task with divine purpose. Their presence wasn't random but purposeful, as if they had been commanded with specific intention.

- **Mecca's Birds:** Some interpretations suggest that at the time, Mecca didn't have such birds. Today, some say these are the same birds that hover around the Kaaba, providing divine protection. This connection emphasizes the continuing protection Allah offers to His sacred house.
- **Protective Birds:** Another interpretation links these birds to the birds that protected Ibrahim (AS) when he was thrown into the fire by Nimrod. This connection reinforces the idea that these birds, sent by Allah, serve as a form of divine protection for the Kaaba.
- This ayah indicates that the birds destroyed the army of Abraha without damaging Makkah at all which was a miracle

Message of this ayah: Allah does not need crazy weapons or miracles to protect/destroy, even birds are enough.

Ayah 4: "تَرْمِيهِمْ بِحِجَارَةٍ مِّن سِجِّيلٍ"
"Striking them with stones of hard clay."

- **Tarmee** means to throw; when present tense is used to describe a past event it implies that it was happening continuously – talking about the stones
- **Bihijaratim min sijjil** stones of baked clay (حِجَارَةٍ مِّن سِجِّيلٍ); were a unique and specific type used by Allah to deliver divine punishment. These stones destroyed the army completely, no person survived.
- **Sinjl** in Farsi refers to pebbles that form on the ground when it rains and then get baked with the extreme heat of the sun.
- Allah can destroy an army of Elephants with dust and birds.
- Ibn Abbas: When a pebble would fall on anyone of them, it caused swelling and it burned and infected their skin.
- This is one of the worst calamities to have hit the Arab world in that location
- **Thunna** shows the **sequence** in which events occurred, marking the structured execution of Allah's will.
- **Historical Context:** **Bilal's parents** were part of the invading army from **Habasha** (Abyssinia). However, **some innocent people** survived, illustrating Allah's mercy, as His punishment did not touch the innocent.

Ayah 5: "فَجَعَلَهُمْ كَعَصْفٍ مَّأْكُولٍ"
"And He made them like eaten straw."

- **Fa** (ف); in Arabic signifies **immediacy**, indicating that Allah's command to send the birds and stones was swift and direct.

- **"Faja'alahum" (فَجَعَلَهُمْ)** means "He made them." Allah has the power to **transform** His creation at will, turning the proud army of elephants into nothingness, as they were crushed and utterly destroyed.
- **"kā'āsifim makūl" (كَعَصَفٍ مَّاكُولٍ)** refers to **straw** that has been **eaten and chewed**—a symbol of how thoroughly the army was wiped out, reduced to a state of utter **humiliation** and destruction.
- Their **skin was ripped off**, symbolizing the violent and crushing effect of the birds' stones, which left them **scattered** and completely destroyed.
- When the pebbles hit him they peeled and burned his skin off as though he was melting. Abraha tried to make it back to Yemen.
- His skin was melting off and he died a gradual painful death. They didn't want to avenge him out of fear that they would get the same disease as him.

The Outcome of Abraha and Attachment to Land

- **Abraha**, despite being a **hanif** still tried violating the **Kaaba**.
- **Excessive Love for His Land:** Abraha's love for his land was so evident that he tried to return to Yemen crawling, even as his skin was torn and peeling off. However, he did not get very far and died on the way. This signifies the divine punishment in place for attacking Allah's sacred designations.
- **Dangers of love for worldly things:** When it overpowers faith, can lead to spiritual destruction. Even though Abu Raha was aware of the sacredness of the Kaaba, his love for his homeland became his downfall.
- **Reflection on Attachment to Land:** We should be cautious when **worldly attachments**—whether to land, people, or things—become more important than our **relationship with Allah**.
- The creation of humans is less miraculous than the ability to learn the Quran and reflect on Allah's guidance. The miracle is in the **knowledge of Allah** and the ability to connect with His words.

MAW and the Sister Refusing to Complete Hajj

- A side story related to excessive love for worldly things (to the extent where we question Allah's decrees)
- **MAW** was speaking to a **sister** who refused to **complete her Hajj**. The reason? She had just learned that **an animal must be slaughtered** as part of the Hajj rituals, and she was reluctant to do it.
- **MAW** spent over **two hours** explaining to her that the **slaughter of animals** during Hajj is part of fulfilling an important **fard** for completing the hajj and exiting the state of ihram. The sister raised concerns about **extinction**, wondering if slaughtering animals was ethically justified.

- To address this, **MAW** took out his phone and **googled** the current state of animal extinction. They found that most of the animals we are permitted to slaughter (like cattle) are **abundant** and even overpopulated, and that **none of them** are on the endangered species list.
- This **proved the barakah** (blessing) in the system. Allah designs systems and practices in perfect balance and with more consideration than we sometimes can see at face value.
- **MAW** explained that while we should care for animals, the **slaughtering during Hajj** is an important ritual and must not be ignored.
- **Lesson:** The act of slaughtering during Hajj is part of **obedience to Allah**. We must understand that fulfilling **fard** actions is a means of obedience.

The Importance of Fulfilling Allah's Commands

- Allah's protection of the Kaaba and the destruction of the army show His absolute sovereignty and power. His commands cannot be overruled by anyone, no matter how strong or powerful they may seem.
- Divine retribution is not just about physical destruction, but about showing that no one can stand in opposition to Allah's will. The army of the elephant was reduced to nothing by a simple command from Allah. Similarly, any worldly attachment should never interfere with the fulfillment of Allah's commands.

No one left Islam in the 7 generations of an Ansar. They had been given the reward for anything. Zaid b. Arqam reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: O Allah,, grant forgiveness to the Ansar, the offspring of the Ansar and the offspring of the offspring of the Ansar. This hadith has been narrated on the authority of Shulba with the same chain of transmitters.

106 | Surah Quraysh

106 | Surah Quraysh

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 106

Order of Revelation: 29

Number of Ayahs: 4

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Safety against fear
- To remove harm and give benefit
- Recognizing Allah's favors

Background

- **Continuation of the themes of Safety and Sustenance from Surah Al Fil**
- **Quraysh Status:** The name **Quraysh** itself comes from the root **qarash** (قَرَش), meaning **trade**. It also means **whale**: Quraysh was the greatest tribe, known for their commercial prowess. This gives a sense of their **dominance** in trade and their key position in the region.
- **Protectors of the Kaaba:** Although Mecca fell into idolatry, as a family and a tribe they were the protectors of the Kaaba. Allah refers to this status in this Surah, and how he gave them special privileges for fulfilling that role.
- The Quraish were highly esteemed. They had two significant trade routes, and Mecca was an economic hub.
- However, Allah's blessings to them were not due to their actions but because the Kaaba was in Mecca.
- **The Kaaba's significance:** Mecca's blessings come from the Kaaba, just as real estate around masjids is more valuable. The presence of religion adds value.

Ayah 1: "إِلَافٍ قُرَيْشٍ"

"For the accustomed security of Quraysh"

- **Ilafi (إِلَافٍ):** The word "ila" is derived from the root word meaning **love, affection, or reverence**. This conveys a sense of deep respect or soft spot. Allah gave Quraysh this special status – a kind of **protection** and **recognition** – that resulted in **security** for them during their travels. It was due to the **love** the people had for the Quraysh that they enjoyed safe passage and security.

- **Contextual Meaning:** Mufti relates it to how **American passports** are recognized around the world, granting holders a level of ease and security at border patrols. Similarly, the Quraysh were given a special status, they were respected and their trade routes were safeguarded.
- It was to the extent that when bandits would attack caravans in border war zones, they'd let the Quraish go free out of loyalty and respect.
- However, they were mistaken in believing that this was something they achieved on their own. This was a favor from Allah due to their connection to the **Kaaba**, and their role as protectors of the House of Allah.

Ayah 2: "رَحْلَةَ الشَّتَاءِ وَالصَّيْفِ"

"Their accustomed security in the winter and the summer"

- **Rehla (رَحْلَة):** Refers to a **journey** or **travel**, particularly for trade purposes. It often indicates a journey that involves effort, with the added meaning that such trips may have been **difficult** or **challenging** due to the conditions.
- While similar to *rehla*, **seer (سَيْر)** refers to travel not just for trade but also with the purpose of **learning** or **contemplation** (hence Seerah) however Allah does not use this word for the Quraish
- They would travel for trade: to **Yemen in the winter** (shitai) and to **Sham in the summer** (saif).
- **Modern Parallel:** Imagine a country that has access to both major superpowers like **America and China** to trade. The Quraysh had this advantage of being allied with two major but opposing regions, and trading with their rich resources.

Ayah 3: "فَلْيَعْبُدُوا رَبَّ هَذَا الْبَيْتِ"

"Let them worship the Lord of this House"

- **Falyabudu (فَلْيَعْبُدُوا):** Fa contains a connotation of immediacy, yabudu means to worship
- **Rabba hadhal bayt:** lord of this house
- The Kaaba directly led to financial and economic gains for the Quraish because it attracted people from everywhere.
- Allah is reminding the Quraysh that this House belongs to Allah and they should worship him immediately.
- **Recognizing Allah's Blessings:** When we struggle with **recognizing Allah**, we should think about the blessings in our lives that we are **most dependent on**. For example, consider your **family, home, shelter**, or even your **senses** (sight, hearing, etc.). These blessings come from Allah, who sustains us in ways we often overlook.

- **Ecosystem of Blessings:** There's a **cyclical nature** to blessings; one blessing often leads to another, just as Allah provides and protects His creation in a continual cycle. Allah even asks the angels, during their shift at **Asr time**, how they found the servants of Allah on earth. This reflects Allah's ongoing care and presence.

Ayah 4: "الَّذِي أَطْعَمَهُمْ مِنْ جُوعٍ وَآمَنَهُمْ مِنْ خَوْفٍ"

"Who has fed them, preventing hunger, and made them safe, protecting them from fear"

- The greatest and most essential needs of a people: **security** and **sustenance**.
- Allah gave them food even though there was no fertile land for fruit or crops in Makkah.
- Allah also gave them security despite the landscape of Makkah making it difficult; the land is in the middle of the desert which makes it open to attack. Despite that, Allah has kept them safe.
- **At'ama (أَطْعَمَهُمْ):** The verb **at'ama** means **to present food**, not just give it. It implies that Allah doesn't just **provide** sustenance, but **presents it**, like how a restaurant serves a meal, it's a gesture of care and attention. This highlights Allah's **generosity** in providing for His servants.
- Az-Zamakhshari: the tanween on ju'ayn and khawfin implies that Allah protected them from the worst types of fear and worst types of hunger.
- **Sustenance:** Atta'amahum min juayn: feeding them from hunger
- **Security:** Wa'amanahum min khawf: security from fear

107 | Surah Al-Maun

107 | Surah Al-Maun

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 107

Order of Revelation: 17

Number of Ayahs: 7

Theme and Subject Matter:

- People who question the Judgement
- Orphans and poor people
- People who are neglectful of their prayers

Background

- In Surah Al-Fil and Surah Quraish, Allah demonstrates the protection afforded to the Meccans. In Surah Al-Ma'un, he highlights their wrongs.
- Despite immense blessings and protection, the Quraysh fail to recognize the truth in the Prophet's ﷺ message and commit both societal and spiritual wrongs.
- The Prophet ﷺ is amazed at their **ingratitude**: how could they deny Allah after all He had done for them?
- **Societal and Spiritual Diseases:** Two primary spiritual defects stand between an average person and Allah:
 - **Selfishness** – neglecting orphans, withholding basic rights like food
 - **Insincerity** – praying heedlessly (spiritual lethargy), showing off
- **Advice from Mufti to students:** Willpower and commitment to Allah and His deen are essential to overcome these spiritual diseases. Sincerity is almost impossible when one is conscious of their actions and intentions.

Ayah 1

أَرَأَيْتَ الَّذِي يُكَذِّبُ بِالْدِّينِ

"Have you seen the one who denies the Recompense?"

- أَرَأَيْتَ (**Ara'aita**) – mirrors *Alam tara* from Surah Al-Fil; rhetorical connection
- Draws attention to those who reject the concept of judgment and accountability on the Day of Recompense.

- Their rejection stems from **unwillingness to change**, not intellectual incapacity.
- **Being a Muslim requires personal reform, submission, and honesty**—incompatible with cheating or injustice.
- Rather than admit resistance, they **deny Islam** altogether.
- **Understanding “Deen”** Derived from *dayn* (debt), emphasizing return and accountability.
- Belief in the Hereafter includes **returning to Allah** and being recompensed for one’s deeds.
- The more one invests in faith and good actions, the greater the return.
- **Challenge of Belief in the Akhirah:** Tawheed (belief in oneness of God) is intuitive, but belief in the afterlife implies moral accountability, which many found challenging.
- Historical note: even the Jews questioned why prophethood came via Ismail rather than Ishaq.
- **Problem of Comfort and Entitlement:** Repeated divine blessings can create false superiority and complacency.
- Surah Al-Ma’un reminds that comfort is not a substitute for **righteousness**.
- **Ibn Al-Qayyim on Overcoming Addiction:** Two essential conditions:
 - Love for reward > hardship of quitting
 - Fear of consequence > fear of change
 - **Nature of Denial (Kadhdhaba)** Denial is self-deceptive; mere belief is insufficient.

Ayah 2

فَذَلِكَ الَّذِي يَدُعُّ الْيَتِيمَ

“That is the one who repulses the orphan”

- Denial of the afterlife leads to **social corruption**, particularly mistreatment of the vulnerable.
- Quraysh oppressed the weak due to attachment to money and power.
- Themes echoed in Surahs Al-Fajr and Ad-Duha.
- Modern parallels: exploitation of vulnerable populations still occurs.
- **Islamic Values vs Qurayshi Behavior**
- Wealth is a **trust (amanah)**; strict rulings exist on treatment of orphans and the poor.
- Ethical compromise cannot be disguised as opportunity.
- **Modern Application:** True Islam is upheld by the **poor and sincere**, not by those seeking validation or social capital.

- **Understanding “Yadu‘u al-Yateem”:** The verb *Da‘a* implies **violently pushing someone away**, not mere neglect.
- Modern context: pushing marginalized communities into suffering.

Ayah 3

وَلَا يَخُضُّ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ الْمِسْكِينِ

“And does not encourage the feeding of the poor”

- “Encourage” (*Hadha*) highlights avoidance of promoting virtue due to hypocrisy.
- Silence about injustice is a modern tactic to avoid accountability.
- **Understanding “Ta‘ām al-Miskīn”:** Refers to **basic survival needs**, not luxury.
- Example: people in Gaza needing only food and safety.
- **Miskīn vs Faqīr**
- **Faqeer** – in need but maintains dignity
- **Miskīn** – visibly poor and destitute
- **Link to Accountability in the Akhirah:** True belief in the Day of Judgment compels **protection of others’ rights**.

Ayahs 4–5

فَوَيْلٌ لِّلْمُصَلِّينَ الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ

“So woe to those who pray, who are heedless of their prayer”

- Rare mention of Salah in Makki Surahs; addresses **heedlessness** and spiritual laziness.
- Surah combines **social critique** (ayahs 2–3) and **spiritual critique** (ayahs 4–5).
- **Understanding “Wayl”:** Means **destruction or deep regret**, reserved for those who pray heedlessly.
- **Munafiqeen’s Attitude Toward Prayer:** Pray carelessly, without humility (*Khushu’*).
- Fajr and Isha are particularly challenging for hypocrites.

Ayah 6

الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَاءُونَ

"Those who make show [of their deeds]"

- Performing deeds for **praise or recognition** corrupts intentions
- Hasan al-Basri: begin for Allah; if seen by others, continue, else intention is corrupted
- Mufti's analogy: like teenagers showing off bad basketball skills.
- The second spiritual disease: showing off

Ayah 7

وَيَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ

"And withhold [even] small assistance"

- *Ma'un* refers to **small help or kindness**, like utensils, tools, or basic aid.
- They **fail to help and block others** from doing good.
- Implies **spiritual blockage**—denying others the opportunity to act righteously.

Key Lessons / Reflections

- Denial of faith stems from unwillingness to uphold **moral responsibility** and **sincerity in worship**.
- Surah addresses both **disbelievers (kafir)** and **hypocrites (munafiq)**.
- Condemns both **social injustice** and **spiritual laziness**.
- True belief in the afterlife **compels ethical behavior**.
- Societal diseases
 - Oppression of the vulnerable
 - Greed with wealth
- Spiritual diseases
 - Heedlessness in prayer
 - Arrogance (showing off)

Original notes

Ayah 1: أَرَأَيْتَ الَّذِي يُكَذِّبُ بِالدِّينِ

“Have you seen the one who denies the Recompense?”

- **أَرَأَيْتَ (Ara'aita):** mirrors *Alam tara* from Surah Al-Fil, drawing a rhetorical connection
- The ayah calls attention to those who reject the concept of judgment and accountability on the Day of Recompense.
 - Their rejection is not intellectual—it stems from an unwillingness to change their lifestyle and submit to divine law.
 - Being a Muslim requires personal reform, submission, and honesty—principles incompatible with cheating or injustice.
 - Rather than admitting their resistance, they deny Islam altogether.

Understanding “Deen”

- The word *Deen* comes from *dayn* (debt), emphasizing the idea of return and accountability.
- Just like a debt is repaid, belief in the Hereafter includes returning to Allah and being recompensed for one's deeds.
- The more one invests in faith and good actions, the greater the return.

Challenge of Belief in the Akhirah (Hereafter)

- Belief in Allah is intuitive—*Tawheed* (oneness of God) comes naturally.
- The Quraysh accepted the Prophet ﷺ's truthfulness due to his impeccable character.
- However, belief in the afterlife was a greater challenge for them, as it implied moral accountability.
- Historically, even the Jews struggled with why prophethood came through the lineage of Ibrahim via Ismail, not Ishaq.

The Problem of Comfort and Entitlement

- Repeated divine blessings can lead to a false sense of superiority and complacency.
- The Jews, for example, were saved from Pharaoh without effort, while Muslims had to fight in battles like Badr.
- Similarly, the Quraysh felt entitled and spiritually blind due to their comfort and power.
- This mindset is still present today: “*My life is fine without Fajr—why should I change?*”
- Surah Al-Ma'un is a divine response: comfort is not a substitute for righteousness.

Ibn Al-Qayyim's Insight on Overcoming Addiction

- Ibn Al-Qayyim states that to leave an addiction, two things are needed:

1. Love for the reward must outweigh the hardship of quitting
2. Fear of the consequence must outweigh the fear of change.

Nature of Denial (*Kadhdhaba*)

- Allah uses the word *Yaqeen* (certainty) regarding the afterlife—mere belief is not enough.

Ayah 2: فَذَلِكَ الَّذِي يَدُعُّ الْيَتِيمَ

“That is the one who repulses the orphan”

- Denial of the afterlife leads to social corruption, especially the mistreatment of the vulnerable.
- They failed to change their behavior because they were deeply attached to money and power.
- They oppressed the weak—orphans, the poor, and anyone without social standing.
- This theme is also found in Surahs *Al-Fajr* and *Ad-Duha*.
- Modern parallels exist: people still exploit the vulnerable and steal wealth through unethical systems.

Islamic Values vs Qurayshi Behavior

- In Islam, wealth is a trust (*amanah*), and there are strict rulings on the treatment of orphans and the poor.
- Allah rebukes the Quraysh directly for their moral failures.
- Sometimes people call unethical actions “opportunity” when in reality it’s compromise.
- Even after accepting Islam, some Quraysh tried to impose conditions and exploit the early Muslim community.

Modern Application

- Aisha (RA) narrated that if the Prophet ﷺ could have removed any verse, it would have been the verse of rebuke in Surah Al-Kahf:
“Do not turn your eyes away from those who remember Allah.”
- Many today use Islam symbolically for image or social capital.
- We do not need validation from celebrities or popular figures.
- True Islam is upheld by the poor and sincere, not by those seeking fame.

Understanding “Yadu‘u al-Yateem”

- The verb *Da‘a* means to violently push someone away, not merely neglect.
 - In today's context, it's like pushing immigrants or the marginalized into suffering or vulnerability.
-

Ayah 3: وَلَا يَحْضُ عَلَىٰ طَعَامِ الْمَسْكِينِ

“And does not encourage the feeding of the poor”

- The word *Hadha* means to encourage; these people don't even talk about feeding the needy.
- Why? Because promoting virtue would expose their own hypocrisy.
- In modern times, silence about injustice is a tactic for avoiding accountability.
- *Wala yahuddu*—they actively avoid discussing basic acts of compassion.

Understanding “Ta‘ām al-Miskīn”

- This is not about enriching the poor, but fulfilling their basic right to food and survival.
- For example, people in Gaza are not asking for luxury—just food and safety.
- *Zakat* is not a handout; it's a form of upliftment meant to support people until they become self-sufficient, ideally within three years.

Miskīn vs Faqīr

- A *faqeer* is someone who is in need but appears well-off, like the Sahabah in Madinah who maintained dignity despite poverty.
- A *miskīn* is visibly and obviously poor—often homeless and without basic necessities.
- *Ta‘ām al-miskīn* refers to giving food to those whose need is evident.

Link to Accountability in the Akhirah

- If a person truly believed in the Day of Judgment, they would feel compelled to protect and serve the rights of others.
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Ayahs 4–5: فَوَيْلٌ لِلْمُصَلِّينَ الَّذِينَ هُمْ عَنْ صَلَاتِهِمْ سَاهُونَ

“So woe to those who pray, who are heedless of their prayer”

- *Salah* is rarely mentioned in Makki Surahs, which typically focus on social justice. But here, the spiritual disease of heedlessness is addressed.
- The surah contains both social (ayahs 2–3) and spiritual (ayahs 4–5) critiques.

- These verses may have Madani relevance, highlighting hypocrisy that emerged in later phases of revelation.

Understanding “Wayl”

- *Wayl* means destruction or deep regret, referring here to the lowest pit of Hell (*Wadi al-Wayl*).
- Ironically, it is reserved not for those who don’t pray—but for those who do, but do so heedlessly.

The Munafiqeen’s Attitude Toward Prayer

- They pray carelessly, without concern for time or quality.
- *Sahu* means unintentional forgetfulness, but in this context, it refers to habitual negligence and spiritual laziness.
- They wait until the last moment and perform it without *Khushu’* (humility).
- They go through the motions like a bird pecking the ground (as described in hadith).
- The hardest prayers for hypocrites are *Fajr* and *Isha*.
- The Prophet ﷺ would smile when Umar noticed who came for Fajr after battle—indicating who was sincere.

Ayah 6: الَّذِينَ هُمْ يُرَاءُونَ

“Those who make show [of their deeds]”

- Despite their poor practice, they still seek praise and recognition.
- Mufti likened it to teenagers showing off bad basketball skills—*“play in the dark,”* he jokes.
- We all seek validation, but it becomes dangerous when we seek it in worship.
- Hasan al-Basri said:

If you begin something for Allah and are later seen, continue. But if you begin for being seen, your intention is corrupted.

- This verse criticizes those who perform good only for show—not for Allah.

Ayah 7: وَيَمْنَعُونَ الْمَاعُونَ

“And withhold [even] small assistance”

- *Ma’un* refers to small, basic items (utensils, help, tools), or even simple kindness.
- They not only fail to help—they prevent others from helping too.

- This verse also implies spiritual blockage: they deny others even the opportunity to do good.
-

Key Lessons from Surah Al-Ma'un

- They reject faith because true belief demands restraint from oppression and sincerity in worship.
- The Surah addresses both the disbeliever (*kafir*) and the hypocrite (*munaḥiq*).
- It condemns both social injustice and spiritual laziness.
- Denying the afterlife leads to denial of moral responsibility.
- Spiritual disease manifests in

108 | Surah Al-Kawthar

108 | Surah Al-Kawthar

Period of Revelation: Makkah (some say Madinan)

Surah Number: 108

Order of Revelation: 15

Number of Ayahs: 3

Theme and Subject Matter:

- **Blessings** Allah gave to the Prophet ﷺ in this life and the next
- **Command for thankfulness** through prayer and sacrifice
- **Condemnation** for the enemies of Allah's Messenger ﷺ
- People who affirm the **Day of Judgement** are addressed in this surah; those who deny it were addressed in Surah Al-Maun
- **Kawthar** comes from kathira, meaning abundance; in this context, focusing on the positives without dismissal

Background

- **Comfort through revelation:** In the early years of **Makkah**, the Muslims were **persecuted**. The Prophet ﷺ received Surah Duha after being targeted—emotional support came from revelation.
- **Prophets Reliance:** The Prophet ﷺ was the most **tested in creation**. This Surah is evidence of how **Allah tests** us by what we can handle, through both **difficult moments** and **blessings**. In his most vulnerable moments, connecting with the **Quran** gave him support.
- **The context:** The Prophet ﷺ lost his son **Qassim** (6–8 months). A difficult loss considering children at this age begin developing **personality**.
- **Abu Qassim** was the Prophet's nickname — among the etiquettes of naming is that no one may take names the Prophet took (this one included).
- Hadith: Khadija RA was crying not because he lost Qassim, but because she worried about how he would survive without his mother's milk in **Jannah**. Jibreel informed the Prophet Allah would open the sky to show her that he is well.
- **Abu Lahab**, the neighbor, harmed the Prophet ﷺ personally. He mocked the Prophet ﷺ in markets, claiming he would have no lineage. Oppressors often target children.
- The **revelation of Surah Kawthar** came amidst immense personal loss. The surah reassures: "Inna aathayna" — Allah gave abundantly even though the Prophet ﷺ suffered loss.

Ayah 1

إِنَّا أَعْطَيْنَاكَ الْكَوْثَرَ

Indeed, We have granted you, [O Muhammad], al-Kawthar

- **Al-Kawthar:** One of the possible meanings is a **river in Jannah**
- Also refers to **abundant good** that Allah gave His Messenger ﷺ
- **Aatha / Aathayna:** unique or exclusive gifts, large gifts; repetition emphasizes Allah's giving nature
- Message: Allah took your child but gave you much more. Whatever you have belongs to Allah
- Lesson: No person who is not a **muhib** has the right to share bad news; don't take pleasure in others' misfortune
- Quran emphasizes the test of losing a child or blessings; Allah tests the Prophet ﷺ so no one can claim he does not understand human suffering
- **Sabr** (patience) teaches restraint; Allah understands you more than you understand yourself
- **Kawthar as abundance**
- **Kawthar as a river in Jannah:** Its banks are of gold, water whiter than milk, sweeter than honey. Its vessels are more than the stars. Even when someone of the ummah is pulled away, Allah will say: "You do not know what he did after you were gone"

Ayah 2

فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَانْحَرْ

So pray to your Lord and sacrifice [to Him alone]

- **Salat:** First sign of gratitude to Allah is prayer. Pray out of thankfulness
- **Nahr / sacrifice:** Slaughtering an animal to seek Allah's pleasure, especially during Eid. Charity accompanies sacrifice
- Solution to hardship is within **deen**, not outside it
- Tears of repentance are heavy; tears of gratitude are light
- Prophet ﷺ would pray at night out of gratitude
- **Hasan al-Basri:** Being stingy with presence and time is worse than being stingy with wealth

Ayah 3

إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ

Indeed, your enemy is the one cut off

- **Abtar:** No lineage, legacy, or prominence
- Allah is assuring the Prophet ﷺ that his lineage and legacy are preserved; the enemy's is cut off
- **Ibn Taymiyyah:** Enemy is cut off from all good in this life and the next
- Historical context: Abu Lahab mocked the Prophet ﷺ, claiming no lineage. Ironically, Abu Lahab's slave girl brought good news of the Prophet's birth; freeing her was a rare yearly benefit
- Lesson: Allah protects the Prophet's ﷺ legacy and punishes the enemy

109 | Surah Al-Kafirun

109 | Surah Al-Kafirun

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 109

Order of Revelation: 18

Number of Ayahs: 6

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Muslims' total **disgust** towards the worship of disbelievers
- Islam and **kufr** have nothing in common
- Bold affirmation of **Islamic identity** and refusal to compromise faith

Background

Pairing

- Surah Al-Kafirun is often paired with Surah Al-Ikhlās; the Prophet ﷺ would consistently recite them together, especially in Sunnah prayers like Fajr and Witr.
- These two surahs represent conscious, daily reaffirmation of identity and belief: Surah Al-Kafirun affirms the choice of being Muslim, and Surah Al-Ikhlās reminds us why we made that choice.
- The surahs in between (Al-Fil to Al-Nas) offer the supporting framework: history, justice, ethics, and theology.
- Every day, Muslims wake up and choose Islam again—we actively decide to submit to Allah and follow His guidance.
- The Quranic structure is divinely ordained; Surahs are paired with wisdom and intention.
- Even when Orientalists question the organization of the Quran, the deeper you look, the more evident the beauty becomes.
- Imam al-Shafi'i said: *One of the greatest blessings in life is that Allah conceals our sins.*
- We go to great lengths to protect worldly blessings—how much more should we protect Tawhid, which is no trivial gift.
- Mufti likened the placement of these surahs to a sandwich: Surah Al-Kafirun and Surah Al-Ikhlās are the bread, and the surahs in between are the filling—guidance, clarity, and details.
- This is the only Surah in the Quran where Allah addresses the disbelievers directly by name through the Prophet ﷺ.

- **Revelation context:**

The leaders of Quraysh, noticing the Prophet ﷺ's followers were few and weak, offered a compromise: one year of following Islam, one year of him following their religion. The Prophet listened silently but did not respond.

- In another version, they could not find the Prophet, so they sent his uncle, Abu Talib, to offer worldly incentives (leadership, wealth, keys to the Kaaba) in exchange for stopping da'wah.
- The Prophet ﷺ responded firmly: *"If you gave me control of the day and night, I would still not give up this message."*

- **Dealing with Temptation & Modern Examples**

- When the door to halal is closed, the door to haram appears more attractive—this is a spiritual test.
- Example: A man wanted to wear his Rolex in ihram, but ihram is meant to eliminate visible signs of status. The lesson: In Islam, humility is elevated.
- You and I are not powerful—haqq (truth) is powerful.
- When Muslims conquered lands, they would call the adhan first—today, people fear that symbolic assertion of Islamic truth, like France banning the hijab. The truth holds weight and presence
- **Personal Reflection: What Is Too Much Loss of Deen?**
- We must ask ourselves: What amount of compromise is too much? When does accommodating the world cross the line into losing deen?

Ayah 1

قل يا ايها الكافرون

"Say, O disbelievers"

- The command "Qul" shows Allah instructing the Prophet ﷺ to speak on His behalf; Allah distances Himself from addressing the disbelievers directly.
- "Qul" implies repetition and affirmation: we are to reaffirm our identity as Muslims consistently.
- "Kafirun" here is not exclusive to the Quraysh leaders; it applies to anyone who behaves like them—those who try to derail or manipulate your beliefs.
- Example: Muslims who change their names from "Muhammad" to "Mo" to blend in—why abandon the name with the highest honor in creation?
- Respecting public Muslim space includes etiquette: picking up trash, speaking quietly, not obstructing space—these are the rights of the path.
- Surround yourself with people who protect, not compromise, your deen.

Ayah 2

لا اعبد ما تعبدون

"I do not worship what you worship"

- **Modern application:** Be clear about your practices. Mufti gives the example of Uber rides—he asks not to play music, saying: *"Our God gave us a book we listen to instead,"* then plays Quran.
- **Avoid preaching or judging:** Mufti avoids labeling things "haram" publicly if it risks pushing people away—clarity with compassion is key.
- Don't overstate your piety; if you avoid something for Allah, just act upon it.
- Example of a masjid in Detroit known for its Mawlid gatherings: formerly surrounded by crack houses, those all moved after the masjid was established—spiritual presence has power.
- Servitude (ubudiyyah) to Allah requires four conditions: obedience, love, reliance (tawakkul), and sincerity.

Ayah 3

ولا انتم عابدون ما اعبد

"Nor are you worshippers of what I worship"

- The Prophet ﷺ addresses the reality of their spiritual state: **they are not sincere worshippers of Allah.**
- The statement refers to the past—"you never truly worshipped what I worship."
- Story: Some companions claimed they never committed shirk. The Prophet ﷺ reminded Abu Bakr that even he entered a temple once in Jahiliyyah—but did you follow me in, he asked? I broke all the idols.
- Rejects the idea that mutual religious compromise is possible.

Ayah 4

ولا انا عابد ما عبدتم

"Nor will I ever worship what you worship"

- This rejects both of the Quraysh's offers—whether shared worship or alternating years.
- It's a final and complete rejection of compromise.
- This verse is specific to those Quraysh leaders; their fate was sealed due to their obstinate rejection.

- Caution: this ayah is not a blanket condemnation of every non-Muslim—it applies to those whose rejection is stubborn and deliberate.

Ayah 5

ولا انتم عابدون ما اعبد

"Nor will you worship what I worship"

- This again affirms that they are incapable or unwilling to worship Allah sincerely.
- The repetition emphasizes irreconcilable spiritual paths.

Ayah 6

لكم دينكم ولي دين

"To you is your religion, and to me is mine"

- "Deen" here means not only "religion," but also accountability, way of life, or consequence (like debt owed).
- This verse is not relativistic—it does not mean all religions are equal. Rather, it declares full separation in belief, values, and afterlife outcome.
- It is a rejection of an inferiority complex: Islam does not need validation through conversions. Even if no one accepts Islam, it remains complete and perfect.
- It's also a finality: the line between belief and disbelief is clearly drawn.

Key Lessons from Surah Al-Kafirun

- This Surah is a bold affirmation of Islamic identity—a refusal to compromise faith for worldly gain.
- It teaches clarity in religious boundaries while maintaining dignity and respect.
- Compromise in din is not allowed when the essence of faith is at stake.
- Truth needs no support from numbers, power, or recognition—it stands by itself.
- We must ask: What is the red line of our faith? What cost is too high?

110 | Surah Al-Nasr

110 | Surah Al-Nasr

Surah Al-Nasr

Period of Revelation: Madinan

Surah Number: 110

Order of Revelation: 114

Number of Ayahs: 3

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Islam has attained complete victory in Arabia
- people have started entering His religion in great numbers
- the mission of the Prophet ﷺ had been fulfilled.

Background

- **The outcome of a believer is always a fath (victory), and for the disbeliever, it is thabbah (destruction).**
- Surah Al-Nasr is the **last complete surah to be revealed** and is classified as a **Madani surah**. This surah corresponds to Surah Al-Kafirun, signaling Allah's **guarantee of victory** for the believers.
- The core difference between believers and disbelievers is highlighted by Surah Ikhlas (the oneness of Allah), while Surah Al-Falaq and Surah An-Nas provide protection.
- The **Fat-h of Mecca** (the conquest of Makkah) coincided with the revelation of this surah. The Prophet received Surah Al-Nasr, and the people rejoiced. However, **Abu Bakr was seen crying**. Umar asked why, and Abu Bakr explained that the Prophet's mission was complete and he would soon leave them.
- Historically, the **Jews reportedly said if they had received this surah, they would have declared that day an Eid**, acknowledging the significance of the Prophet's victory. But in Islam we do not determine celebrations through choice. Eid is set.
- Umar's council included both seniors and juniors, among them **Abdullah ibn Abbas**. When questioned about the meaning of Ayah 3, Ibn Abbas explained it was a sign to the Prophet that his mission was complete and that Allah would call him back soon. Ibn Abbas was on Umar's council despite his young age due to his understanding of the Quran.

Ayah 1:

إِذَا جَاءَ نَصْرُ اللَّهِ وَالْفَتْحُ

"When the help of Allah comes and the victory,"

- A pattern to notice is that whenever Allah's help (nasr (النصر) arrives, it comes together with victory (fath (الفتح).
- This is why Muslims should seek Allah's help not only during major events but in every moment of life, making dua for even the simplest things.
- When things go well, attributing success to Allah strengthens our faith and builds a sincere connection.
- One must learn to recognize everyday moments as opportunities where Allah accepts prayers, which builds conviction when making dua.
- The best time to make dua is after acts of obedience, reinforcing the idea that Allah supports those who strive in His cause.
- Mufti highlights dua here because this ayah encourages us to build a close rapport with Allah by consistently seeking His help.

Ayah 2:

وَرَأَيْتَ النَّاسَ يَدْخُلُونَ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ أَفْوَاجًا

"And you see the people entering into the religion of Allah in multitudes,"

- The believers didn't merely convert to Islam; they **marched into it with enthusiasm and excitement.**
- The term فَتْحُ (fath) is interpreted in various ways: some say it means conquering land, others see it as paying debts, and others view it as population increase. Here, it primarily signifies the rapid growth of the Muslim community.
- أَفْوَاجًا (afwaja) refers specifically to three groups: Meccans, people from Taif, and Yemenis.
- More than **30,000 people from Yemen** alone accepted Islam around this time.
- The **Fath of Mecca occurred in the 8th year after Hijra**, while the Treaty of Hudaibiyyah took place in the 6th year, and the final pilgrimage (Hajj) was in the 10th year. Two years after Hudaibiyyah, the Muslim population was about 10,000; by the time this surah was revealed, it had grown to approximately 125,000.
- Allah emphasizes that what made this victory a true victory was this mass acceptance of Islam, showing that victory might not come instantly but sometimes takes years to manifest fully. It took 21 years for the Prophet to witness this.
- Imam Ahmad recorded from Abu `Ammar that a neighbor of Jabir bin `Abdullah RA told him, "I returned from a journey and Jabir bin `Abdullah came and greeted me. So I began to talk with him about the divisions among the people and what they had started doing. Thus, Jabir began to cry and he said, 'I heard the Messenger of Allah Say "Verily, the people have entered into the religion of Allah in crowds and they will also leave it in crowds."

Ayah 3:

فَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ وَاسْتَغْفِرْهُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ تَوَّابًا

"Then exalt [Allah] with praise of your Lord and ask forgiveness of Him. Indeed, He is ever Accepting of repentance."

- The word فَ (fa) implies immediacy; as soon as victory comes, the believer should begin praising and seeking forgiveness from Allah.
- Sincerity means worshipping Allah regardless of whether others are watching or not. True devotion is independent of external validation (victory in this case).
- We seek forgiveness (استغفار) after good deeds to ensure we do not mistakenly take credit for what is actually Allah's grace.
- It is a humble acknowledgment that no matter how flawed we are, Allah allows us to pray and worship Him, as no other master would accept a flawed servant.
- Extra: The phrase لَا تَحْرِمْنَا ("do not deprive us") reflects a heartfelt plea to never be denied the opportunity to worship despite human imperfection.
- Lastly this ayah is a reminder to do abundant istighfar.
- No day should go by except that we do istighfar. One of the things shaytan will trick you into thinking is that you need a specific environment to make istighfar
- After a big sin you might think istighfar isn't enough. Never lose your reliance on it.
- 3 main istighfars from the Prophet to know and recite often.
- You would be foolish to think that a spiritually good day is a day you don't need to do istighfar.
- Hadith about 100 istighfar, and the guarantee of jannah
- There's an ayah in Surah Kahf. What does al baqiyyatu salihat 18:46 mean? A man asked the prophet this. He responded there is no question (3x) this is in regards to dhikr
- Allah's mercy is not empowerment to sin, its encouragement to seek forgiveness after sin (and even good deeds)
- What does tawbatin nasuhah mean? Sincere repentance.
- 1. Immediate regret 2. Firm vow to not return 3. Leaving anything that is a caller to that sin.
- Nus or naseeha are root words. Nasuha means sincere.

Selected Vocabulary

- Victory – Nasr (النصر)
- Conquest – Fath (الفتح)
- Groups / Multitudes – Afwaj (أفواج)

Key Lessons & Reflections

- Divine victory is a sign of Allah's help; believers must attribute success to Allah.
- Growth of Islam took time; mass acceptance validates true victory.
- Immediately glorify, praise, and seek forgiveness from Allah after success.
- Regular istighfar and sincere repentance maintain spiritual health, even after achieving great victories.
- Victory is both an external achievement (fath) and an internal spiritual task (tasbeeh, hamd, istighfar).

111 | Surah Al-Masad

111 | Surah Al-Masad

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 111

Order of Revelation: 6

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Dedicated to Abu Lahab and his Wife

Background

- **Why did Allah use the example of Abu Lahab?**
- Despite being enemies of Islam, many of the disbelievers respected the Prophet because he was part of nobility. He was even known as the “trustworthy one” (Al-Amin) because people trusted him with their wealth and entrusted him with carrying their money.
- However, Abu Lahab was an exception. He took personal shots at the Prophet, and his hostility went beyond words. His two sons, who were married to the Prophet’s daughters, even divorced them after he declared his Prophethood.
- His actions, such as sending someone to throw dirt behind the Prophet and his wife leaving dung in the Prophet’s path, further exemplify his deep-seated hostility.

The Death of Abu Lahab:

- Abu Lahab suffered a dreadful death where his skin deteriorated, and people abandoned him because they thought the disease was contagious. He died a dishonorable death (which was of high priority to the Arabs), deprived of any dignity in his final moments. His family even sent slaves to drag his body to the cemetery.
- One of his sons, who had also divorced the Prophet’s daughter disrespectfully, was killed by a lion while traveling. This is a reminder that even if someone forgives you, Allah must also forgive.
- A parallel story: **Hasan ibn Thabit**, the poet of the Prophet, was caught spreading the false accusations against Aisha (RA). Though he was forgiven by her, he became blind later in his life. He attributed this blindness to the wrong he had done, as Allah had not forgiven him.
- **Contrast with Abu Jahal:** Abu Jahal, another enemy of Islam, when being executed even asked for his neck to be severed from the bottom so that his neck

would appear longer. He wanted to day in a way that would preserve his image, showing how obsessed they were with their reputations.

- **The Meaning of Abu Lahab's Death:** Abu Lahab's death was a lesson in divine retribution. His suffering and the indignity with which he was treated in death reflect the consequences of his hostility and arrogance toward the Prophet.
-

Ayah 1

تَبَّتْ يَدَا أَبِي لَهَبٍ وَتَبَّ

May the hands of Abu Lahab be ruined, and ruined is he

- **Tabba (تَبَّتْ):** Allah uses the same word for "slow destruction" (تَبَّتْ) that Abu Lahab used against the Prophet.
- **"يَدَاهُ" (Yadaah):** refers to the hands, which are a primary tool for causing harm. This highlights how Abu Lahab actively sought to harm the Prophet physically and verbally.
- **The Incident at Mount Safa:**
When the Prophet went to the top of Mount Safa and asked the people if they would believe him if he said there was an army behind the mountain, they responded affirmatively, saying he was truthful.
- He then warned them, saying, "There is a punishment above your heads." Abu Lahab responded with, "تَبَّتْ لَكَ يَا مُحَمَّدُ" ("Tabbat laka ya Muhammad").
- "تَبَّتْ" (Tabbat) refers to a slow, deteriorating destruction, a painful and excruciating kind of ruin. He questioned the Prophet: "Did you gather us for something like this?"
- **Abu Lahab's Hostility:** Since Abu Lahab was the first to speak out against the Prophet
- Allah responds directly to him in this ayah.
- **Why did Allah say "Tabba" twice?** Allah repeats it for emphasis. Abu Lahab's destruction is certain, slow, and painful—just as he wished for the Prophet. Some narrations say Abu Lahab said the word twice to the Prophet
- Tabba is connected to abtar from Surah Kawthar

Ayah 2:

"مَا أَغْنَىٰ عَنْهُ مَالُهُ وَمَا كَسَبَ" (Ma aghna 'anhu maluhu wa ma kasab)

His wealth will not avail him or that which he gained

- **"مَا أَغْنَىٰ" (Ma aghna)** means "will not benefit him." His wealth and what he has accumulated in this life will provide no protection for him in the Hereafter.

- "مَالُهُ" (Maluhu) refers to his wealth specifically.
- "وَمَا كَسَبَ" (Wa ma kasab) refers to everything he has earned—his wealth, his status, and his children. None of it will be of any benefit now.
- The meaning of this ayah is exactly that: wealth will not help him, nor will anything he earned in life.
- **The Couple's Nobility and Pride:** Abu Lahab and his wife used to flaunt their status and background, but it's being reduced. They were both from powerful tribes, both considered the most attractive (to the extent that his wife's nickname was Umm Jameela). Their wealth, lineage, and power are rendered utterly useless in the Hereafter.
- But Abu Lahab will not be able to pay his way out of punishment as he might have been able to in dunya.
- Some might say that if wealth doesn't help him, his children will, but Allah decrees that **nothing** will help him. His wealth and lineage will not provide him any defense on the Day of Judgment.

Alternate note:

- "سَارِعٌ" (Sar) vs. "سَوْفٌ" (Sawfa): Whenever Allah speaks about the future for disbelievers, He uses "سَارِعٌ" (Sar), indicating speed and urgency. Abu Lahab's punishment will occur swiftly
- "سَوْفٌ" (Sawfa) is used for the pious, indicating gentleness and weight.

Ayah 3:

"سَيَصْلَى نَارًا ذَاتَ لَهَبٍ" (Seyasla naran dhata lahab)

He will [enter to] burn in a Fire of [blazing] flame

- The term "يَصْلَى" (Yasla) often refers to something being grilled or burned, which evokes an image of intense, painful suffering
- **The Nickname:** Abu Lahab is not his real name, it is actually a nickname that is given to him for his handsome face (pale and rosy cheeked) for which they nicknamed him Father of Fire.
- When these verses are revealed, the Quran's use of his nickname actually adds extra offense. His name Abu Lahab being used in such a negative context and with such vocabulary leads to public shame.
- For the believers: Allah immortalizes Abu Lahab as the one who will burn in the fire of **Jahannam** for his wrongdoing towards the Prophet.

Ayah 4: وَأَمْرَأَتُهُ حَمَّالَةَ الْحَطَبِ

And his wife [as well] - the carrier of firewood

- Despite the spousal relationship, there is no honor in it for her. The term "امرأة" (**Imra'ah**) is used here, which is often used for women who have no virtue in their marriage (e.g., the wives of Prophet Lut and Prophet Nuh). Doesn't necessarily have a negative context though, since it's also used for Asiya (and her relationship to Firaun)
- **Her Role in the Harm:** Abu Lahab's wife actively participated in humiliating the Prophet, such as placing firewood in the Prophet's path. Allah uses this imagery to describe her role in spreading harmful rumors about the Prophet.
- "حَمَّالَةَ الْحَطَبِ" (**Hammaalat al-hatab**) This phrase refers to someone who carries firewood. In this context, it symbolizes how she would fuel the fire of rumors, gossip, and malice against the Prophet.
- Allah's words reflect how her actions of spreading rumors and harming the Prophet would come back to her, fueling the fire of Hell for eternity.
- **The Two Qira'at:** There are two versions for this verse:
"حَمَّالَةَ الْحَطَبِ" (**Hammaalat al-hatab**), which suggests she will continuously fuel the fire of Hell, reigniting it whenever it dims.
"حَمَّالَةَ الْحَطَبِ" (**Hammaalatul hatab**) with a dhamma on the taa, which indicates she will light the fire once. Ultimately, Jahannam does not really need her to sustain its fire.
- But she will still be forced to participate as a form of punishment and reminder for how she "fueled the fire" (encouraged her husband's wrongs) in dunya.

Ayah 5: فِي جِيدِهَا حَبْلٌ مِّن مَّسَدٍ (Fi jeediha hablun min masad)

Around her neck is a rope of [twisted] fiber

- **Word choice:** "جِيدِهَا" (**jidiha**) is a derogatory way of saying "neck," contrasting with "عُنُقٍ" (**Unuq**), which would be an honorable term for the neck.
- **Hablum:** rope
- **Symbolism of the Rope:** The "rope" (حَبْلٌ) made of fire refers to the torment awaiting her in the Hereafter. It alludes to the fiber she used to make her slaves carry wood to harm the Prophet. Her actions in this life will lead to this painful and humiliating punishment.
- **Why is the Surah named Al-Masad?**
- The Prophet ﷺ would often assign names to surahs based on the dominant themes or the most notable elements. In this case, the name "Al-Masad" (the Palm Fiber) relates to the imagery of the rope of fire and the cruel, degrading actions of

Abu Lahab and his wife.

Extra Notes:

- When the prophet received wahi, he would deliver the info to the disbelievers as well.
- Meccans were the allies of the persians as believers of shirk.
- Allah will never create us with a dominant nature inclining towards evil
- MAR often uses the example of his moms vegetable garden
- Arrogance is the biggest barrier to belief
- Hasan al basri: how do we know the heart is alive? It feels regret
- Ibn abbas says there are certain things which are worse than the actual sin. The one who feels fulfillment after completing the sin. When you feel remorse for missing out on the sin, when allah saved you from it is worse than the sin itself
- The concept of FOMO. You should only feel FOMO towards good things.
- Another thing: having more haya in front of others than you do in front of allah.

112 | Surah Al-Ikhlās

112 | Surah Ikhlas

Period of Revelation: Makkan

Surah Number: 112

Order of Revelation: 92 (approximate, varies by source)

Number of Ayahs: 4

Theme and Subject Matter: Affirmation of Allah's absolute oneness, purity, and uniqueness; negation of all false claims about Allah.

Background of Revelation

- Makki: Not every surah has a background of revelation, but this one does.
- The Arabs believed lineage was what gives people honor.
- They demanded an answer from the Prophet regarding Allah's lineage
- This surah was how the Quran supported the Prophet in answering.
- Imam Ahmad recorded from Ubayy bin Ka'ab that the idolaters said to the Prophet, *"O Muhammad! Tell us the lineage of your Lord."* So Allah revealed this surah.
- Ibn Kathir quoted a narration from 'Ikrimah: *when the Jews said "We worship 'Uzayr, the son of Allah", and the Christians said "We worship the Messiah ('Isa), the son of Allah" and the Zoroastrians said "We worship the sun and the moon" and the idolaters said "We worship idols", Allah revealed this Surah to His Messenger صلى الله عليه وسلم.*
- Every part of Surah Ikhlas is a response to some claim that the Prophet received. Time has corrupted the meaning of tawheed despite Allah sending a clear message with all the previous prophets. This surah is a refute to the people of the other religions, who came to the Prophet with altered perspectives on monotheism.
- Why is it called Surah Ikhlas? Ikhlas, meaning sincerity and purity. Allah is purifying all the claims that have been made about. OR that this surah has the capacity to purify a believer with every recitation

Allah is introducing himself. The significance of introductions and the name "Allah".

Mufti relates it to Firaun's first reaction to declarations of worship.

- **The Quranic story:** when the magicians witnessed Moses' miracle and realized it was divine truth, they immediately prostrated and declared: "We believe in the Lord of Aaron and Moses." (Quran 20:70)
- Pharaoh initially thought they were referring to him when they said "rabbi" (my Lord). He had declared himself a god to his people, and expected absolute submission. He couldn't comprehend their instant recognition of the true Lord

- The magicians weren't just affirming belief, they were specifically negating Pharaoh's false claim to divinity by clearly identifying whose Lord they now believed in.

Virtue and Reward of Surah Al-Ikhlās

- The Prophet recommended that Surat al-Ikhlās, Surah Falaq, and Surah Nas each be recited three times in the morning and evening, stating: They will suffice you against everything.
- The most beautiful surah in regards to virtue. You get the reward of reciting ⅓ of the Quran.
- Mufti compares the reward of this surah to other rewards promised in Islam ex: when your mother smiles at you, you get the reward for umrah.
- Al-Bukhari recorded from Abu Sa'īd: *one person heard another repeatedly reciting Surah al-Ikhlās. In the morning he went and informed the Prophet ﷺ in a manner undermining the importance of the surah. The Prophet ﷺ said: By He in whose hands is my life; it is equal to one third of the Qur'ān.*

Why ⅓?

1. To provide a frame of reference for reward. Despite being one of the shortest surahs in the Quran, Allah is showing that its message and importance are great and reflecting upon it deeply carries high reward.
2. To emphasize its summation of one of the 3 main themes of the Quran: tawheed. The 3 being: (akhirah, risalah (prophethood), and tawheed (oneness of god))

Story of the Sahabi Who Loved This Surah

- A'isha RA said: *The Prophet ﷺ sent a man as the commander of a war expedition. The commander would lead his companions in prayer with recitation of a portion of the Qur'an and would complete his recitation with the recitation of this Surah. Upon returning, they mentioned this habit of their leader to the Prophet ﷺ. He asked them to inquire from him his reason for reciting al-Ikhlās in every rak'ah. He replied: Because it is a description of Al-Rahman and I love to recite it. So the Prophet ﷺ said: Inform him that Allah Most High loves him.*
- "Bi hubbi tawheed" - the man, as a former Christian, loved the surah for making it clear to him who Allah is.

- In the narration of the Book of Salah, al-Bukhari mentioned that the Prophet ﷺ said: *"Your love for this Surah has gained you admission to Paradise."*
- Prophetic wisdom: the Prophet was careful not to assume the man was innovating prayer, he gave him a chance to explain.
- The significance of Surah Ikhlas: loving this surah means loving Allah and vice versa.

Prophetic Methodology in Questioning

- The Prophet was always very careful when questioning people or raising doubts with people. He always gave them a chance to explain themselves, as seen in the example of the Imam that recited Surah Ikhlas.
- This can be seen in the story of Ka'ab Ibn Malik, who stayed back from the Battle of Tabuk without a good excuse (didn't have an excuse but did not lie either). The Prophet would always ask people what they were doing and why they were doing it.
- The story of Hatib ibn Abi Balta'ah
- Hatib, a Badr veteran, secretly sent a letter to Mecca warning them of the Prophet's planned attack before the Conquest of Mecca
- The Prophet ﷺ received divine revelation about the letter and sent Ali, Az-Zubair, and Al-Miqdad to intercept it from a woman courier
- When confronted, Hatib explained he wasn't a hypocrite but was trying to protect his family since he had no tribal connections in Mecca like other emigrants did
- Umar RA asked for permission to execute Hatib, the Prophet ﷺ defended Hatib saying "He participated in the battle of Badr, and who knows, perhaps Allah has already looked at the Badr warriors and said, 'Do whatever you like, for I have forgiven you.'"
- "Innahu badriun" - The Prophet gave him full confidence, he's a badri.

Principle of Negation in Islam

- Negation is more important in Islam than affirmation.
- Abu Ayyub Al-Ansari narrated that: *The Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) said: "Whoever comes worshipping Allah and not associating anything with Him, establishing Salah, paying Zakah and avoiding major sins, Paradise will be his."*
- Generally speaking it's easier to add good deeds than it is to leave sins behind.
- Why is this related to Surah Ikhlas? A principle theme of Surah Ikhlas is negation of the claims that have been made against Allah (associating partners and human traits, etc)
- **Mufti's advice for talks:** when delivering a talk, try to avoid speaking too much about sin. Sometimes placing greater emphasis on doing good deeds is the first step to building imaan. Focus on that which is easier for people, you don't want them to feel attacked.

Tafsir Ayah by Ayah

Ayah 1: قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ

"Say that He is Allah who is Ahad (One)."

- **"Wahid" (واحد)** = Numerical One: Used for things that are "one" within a category - like one person among people, one book among books. It implies there could be others of the same type.
- **"Ahad" (أحد)** = Absolute Uniqueness: Used for something completely unique and incomparable that cannot be part of any category. Nothing else exists like it - it stands completely alone.
- **Why Allah is "Ahad" not "Wahid"**: Allah is not "one god among potential gods" but rather the absolutely unique Being who transcends all categories and comparisons. "Ahad" emphasizes rejecting all partnership and affirming Allah's complete incomparability - this is pure Tawheed. **Ahad means:** one, independent, unique and rejecting partnership.
- **"Huwa" (هو)** - Divine Precision: The pronoun "He" specifically refers back to Allah - not a generic statement about oneness, but a precise declaration about this specific being's absolute uniqueness. Every word in the Quran is chosen with perfect wisdom to convey the most accurate theological meaning.
- **Selective vs. Complete Acceptance:** The Jews had a selective attitude toward angels: they considered Jibreel their "enemy" because he brought divine punishment and harsh messages and they preferred Mikaeel because he was associated with sustenance (rizq) and mercy.
- **"Qul Huwa Allahu Ahad"** demands complete acceptance of Allah's absolute oneness - you cannot pick and choose parts of Allah's nature.
- **"Qul" (Say) Command:** Just as the Prophet ﷺ had to declare the complete message (even parts Jews disliked), the command "Say" emphasizes declaring the complete truth about Allah without selective theology.
- **True Tawheed vs. Designer God:** The story illustrates the human tendency to want a "designer God" who only brings pleasant things, while Surah Al-Ikhlās corrects this by affirming Allah's complete, indivisible unity that includes all his attributes.

Ayah 2: اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ

"Allah, As-Samad (The Eternal Refuge)."

There are 3 definitions offered for As-Samad (الصَّمَدُ) in this ayah.

Abdullah ibn Abbas's Definition of As-Samad "What everything relies upon"

Who was Ibn Abbas: Abdullah ibn Abbas had the nickname Hibr al-Ummah wa Turjuman al-Quran (The Scholar of the Nation and Interpreter of the Quran). He was the Prophet's صلی اللہ علیہ وسلم cousin, embraced Islam as a child, stayed close to the Prophet صلی اللہ علیہ وسلم after the conquest of Mecca, and the Caliphs held him in high regard.

- **Universal Dependence:** Allah is the ultimate destination for all needs. Every single thing in creation - from the smallest atom to the largest galaxy - has Allah as its final point of reliance.
- **The Mother-Baby Analogy:** A baby is completely dependent on the mother for survival. But even this purest human relationship eventually becomes mutual - the mother gets emotional fulfillment, purpose, love back
- Only Allah gives with zero return benefit to Himself
- This shows Allah's **absolute transcendence** - He needs nothing from what He sustain.
- **The Spiritual Reality:** people can have intellectual belief in Allah but practical reliance on other things (money, power, love, resources)
- When you truly understand As-Samad your heart feels **faqr** (spiritual poverty) toward Allah. You realize **everything else** is just a **means** (sabab), not the true source.
- You make that dua: "Don't leave me alone for even the blink of an eye"

اللَّهُمَّ رَحْمَتَكَ أَرْجُو فَلَا تَكِلْنِي إِلَى نَفْسِي طَرْفَةَ عَيْنٍ وَأَصْلِحْ لِي شَأْنِي كُلَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ

Allahumma rahmataka arju, fa la takilni ila nafsi tarfata 'aynin, wa aslih li sha'ni kullahu, la ilaha illa ant

"O Allah! Your mercy is what I hope for. Do not leave me to myself for the blink of an eye, and set right all my affairs for me. There is no god but You."

- **The Creation Purpose:** Allah did not create Adam to add him to a list of creations, or to fulfill something. Allah's act of creation wasn't to **gain** anything, but to **manifest** His attributes of mercy, sustenance, and lordship.
- He is the **only being** in existence that gives **pure, one-way sustenance** without any need or benefit to Himself. This is the foundation of true Tawheed.
- **One way relationship:** Allah does not benefit from us. Allah did not create Adam to add him to a list of creations, or to fulfill something.
- **Infinite reliance:** There is no thing on the earth which Allah relies on, but all of it relies on him, for all of time.
-

2. Second meaning: the one who is free from blemishes or faults

3. Third meaning: the everlasting Masood (مصمود) - the one to whom people turn to in times of need.

Complete Definition of As-Samad (الصمد):

- The one who is enough
- The One who is not in need of anyone else, and He is always above them in status or attribute; None can overpower Him.
- The One who is free from blemishes or faults
- The Everlasting
- Masmood (مصمود) - the one to whom people turn to in times of need
- The reason why As Samad comes after Ahad is because sometimes when people are alone they are also lonely, but this is not the case for Allah. Allah is relied on but does not need to rely.

Ayah 3: لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ

"He neither begets nor is born."

- Lam is used, the past tense negation removes all forms of birth associated with Allah in the past. It removes claims of Allah having daughters who are angels or sons.
- Allah does not share attributes with his creation.
- Mufti mentions: thin line between arrogance and confidence. Arrogance is thinking you can get it done without Allah.
- Begets means produce children.

Ayah 4: وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ

"Nor is there to Him any equivalent."

- Allah has no weak points, no flaws, there is no being equal to him.
- Kufu - a partner, or an equal opposition in battle.
- كفو means equal, means partner (spouse), partner (business), equal enemy.
- Allah negates having any equals or partners, nor is he in any need of them like humans are, and even clarifies that a partner would not be able to do what Allah does or challenge him.
- له is placed earlier in the sentence, showing specificity (takdeem (تقديم))
- There is nothing that is equal to Allah in His Uniqueness.

Fakhrud-deen ar-Razi said:

- The first part of the surah shows Allah's Oneness.
- The second part shows Allah's Grace and Mercy upon us because He helps us when we are in need of Him.
- The third part shows that Allah is free from weakness

113 | Surah Al-Falaq

113 | Surah Al-Falaq

Period of Revelation: Maddinan and other say Makkan

Surah Number: 113

Order of Revelation: Approx. 112

Number of Ayahs: 5

Theme and Subject Matter:

- Seeking refuge with Allah from all evils of the creation
- Existence of black magic, witchcraft, evil-eye etc. and their remedy

Background

- Surah Al-Falaq is a **Mu'awwidhah** (a chapter of seeking refuge) along with Surah An-Nas.
- Focuses on **protection from external evils** such as natural harm, darkness, magic, and envy.
- Highlights **practical reliance on Allah** rather than fear of worldly forces.
- Allah teaches that **every form of harm comes from His creation**, and He alone is the ultimate refuge.
- **More about seeking protection from humans than it is Shaytan.**
 - Shaytan does influence people, but ultimately things like envy come from humans.
 - A Jewish woman did magic on the Prophet ﷺ using 12 knots of his hair.
 - Hence, be cautious with how you dispose of your hair; tying hair is a way black magic is done.
- **Black magic is a form of shirk.**
 - Only two things take you out of the fold of Islam: rejecting the oneness of God and black magic.
 - Other sins are wrong but do not take you out of Islam.
- After the black magic was done on the Prophet ﷺ, he started to feel lethargic.
 - Be mindful of excessive lethargy; it could be a sign of black magic, but don't be excessively paranoid.
- **'Aayn' (evil eye) is haqq (true).**
 - Evil eye is real; be careful to recite Surah Falaq and Surah Nas.
 - The Prophet ﷺ would shiver and feel a burden on his back.
 - Whosoever recites Surah Yasin in the morning will be protected from everything.
 - Be mindful of sharing everything online.

- 'Aayn' can simply be infatuation; it doesn't have to be ill-intended. Hasad (envy) is more specific.
- **Kasr** is connected to Shaytan, the whisper, the poking. Be mindful of laziness; Shaytan is making you lazy.
- Yawning in Salah – the Prophet ﷺ says not to yawn.
- Not everything is black magic, and not everything is Shaytan.
- **Key reminder:** focus less on what other people are doing to you, and more on what you are doing to them.
- This surah teaches **protection** and reminds us of the human mind's potential for harm if unchecked.

Etiquettes

- Recite on your own for as long as possible.
 - Aisha RA would blow on the Prophet ﷺ when he couldn't recite it anymore.
 - The Prophet ﷺ also blew on water; permissible to do for children.
 - This is **not bid'ah**, but do not rely on it excessively; rely on Allah.
- **Tabeez** is not haram unless you believe the amulet holds more power than Allah.
- Continue reciting the surah even if protection is not visibly apparent.
 - Even the Prophet ﷺ was affected; recitation is still essential.

Ayah 1: قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ الْفَلَقِ

"Say, I seek refuge in the Lord of daybreak."

- **Al-Falaq (الْفَلَق)**: daybreak; also conveys splitting or opening (like seeds growing).
- **Symbolism**: Allah brings light and life, dispelling darkness.
- **Aootho (seek refuge)**: a human seeks protection like a child with their mother.
 - Emphasis on **feeling safe**, not just being safe.
 - Best ruqya is on oneself; others may help only if they have certainty.
 - Spiritual experience: feeling protected even amidst negative thoughts.
- **Falaq**: to rip open, daybreak. Bad things happen at night; Allah brings light. Shayateen are more active at night.

Ayah 2: مِنْ شَرِّ مَا خَلَقَ

"From the evil of that which He created."

- **Sharr** = lack of good, not independent evil.
- Evil is part of creation; Allah alone protects.
- The Prophet ﷺ emphasized repeating praise after hearing harm.
- **Evil can come from anything (ma) or humans/jinn (khalaq).**
- **Ma:** Protection extends to animals, people, or any created thing.
- **Khalaq:** creations, specifically refers to man and jinn (not generalized creation)

Ayah 3: وَمِنْ شَرِّ غَاسِقٍ إِذَا وَقَبَ

“And from the evil of darkness when it settles.”

- **Ghasiq:** deep night, pitch black.
- **Waqab:** darkness implies permanence.
- Nighttime is when evil acts occur; ibadah during vulnerable times is more rewarding.
- Even the night before Eid is a reminder to guard oneself.

Ayah 4: وَمِنْ شَرِّ النَّفَّاثَاتِ فِي الْعُقَدِ

“And from the evil of the blowers in knots.”

- Refers to **sorcery or magic**, blowing on tied knots (**uqad**).
- Linguistic notes:
 - **Nafath:** blow lightly with saliva.
 - **Nafakha:** blow very hard.
- Real-world application: recite with certainty when crossing dangerous or unknown situations.
- Magic can be generational and hard to detect.

Ayah 5: وَمِنْ شَرِّ حَاسِدٍ إِذَا حَسَدَ

“And from the evil of an envier when he envies.”

- **Hasad (jealousy):** common root of harm, including black magic.
- Exceptions: jealousy of someone spending in Allah’s cause, or granted wisdom and applying it rightly.
- Hasad = oxymoron of gratitude. Practice gratitude to prevent jealousy.
- Deen-focused jealousy is acceptable for inspiration; dunya-focused jealousy is discouraged.
- Practical advice: compare to the best for deen ambition; compare to the worst for dunya to avoid envy.

- **Origin of 'shar':** from sharara = small flame; evil can start small but spread.
- Only **two diseases of the heart continue into the Akhirah**: hasad and khibr (arrogance).
- **Ghibta** = positive jealousy.
- There was a sahaba looking at another sahaba and was staring.

114 | Surah An-Nas

114 | Surah An-Nas

Period of Revelation: Madinnan and others say Makkan

Surah Number: 114

Order of Revelation: 21

Number of Ayahs: 6

Theme & Subject Matter

- Existence of evil whisperers among mankind and jinn.
- Seeking refuge in Allah from the whispers of Shaytan and evil in humans
- internal spiritual protection
- reassurance of Allah's power as Protector

Background

- Surah An-Nas, along with Surah Al-Falaq, was recited by the Prophet ﷺ to undo the knots of magic placed upon him before Khaybar.
- Addresses **internal spiritual struggles** a person may face, particularly **waswas** (whispers, doubts, and negative thoughts).
- Allah emphasizes His **greatness and protective capacity**, showing that one can only feel truly safe when under the care of Someone capable of ultimate protection.
- Applies to **self-doubt**: waswas can be treated by realizing Allah's power exceeds our own deficiencies.
- If the **soul and heart feel safe**, external circumstances become less distressing.
- Highlights the balance of **fear and hope**, as reliance on Allah provides reassurance.

Reason for Revelation / Context

- Before Khaybar, the Prophet ﷺ had magic cast upon him. Twelve knots tied with his hair were removed via recitation of Surah Al-Falaq and Surah An-Nas.
- Reciting these Surahs untied the knots and cured him, demonstrating their **protective and spiritual efficacy**
- Prophet ﷺ recommended these Surahs as **primary protection against harm from jinn and mankind**.
- Al Muawidhatayyn.

Ayah 1: قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ النَّاسِ

"Say, 'I seek refuge in the Lord of mankind.'"

- **Qul** (Say) emphasizes **repetition** and **regularity** in seeking refuge, a pattern across the four Quls
- **Aootho (seek refuge)**: a human seeks protection like a child with their mother.
 - Emphasis on **feeling safe**, not just being safe.
 - Best ruqya is on oneself; others may help only if they have certainty.
 - Spiritual experience: feeling protected even amidst negative thoughts.
- **Rabb** derives from *Murabbi* (caretaker)
 - Meanings: **ownership, lordship, and care.**
 - Rabb is the first and last quality appearing in the Quran. It connotes ownership.
 - Allah is our master and we are slaves and it is a reminder we need because sometimes we get too comfortable.
 - Rabb as **ownership**: Allah has clear access to us. Do we really own anything? If we can access it but don't have full rights over it, do we really own it? Example: owning a house. You can't just add an extension whenever you want. You have ownership but you are not rabb.
 - Rabb as **lordship**: this meaning is a comfort. A person can feel so broken, but knowing that Allah's access to us never changes. In another surah Allah says tanzi-ul mulk, that he has complete access to pull something from its roots.
 - Rabb as **caretaker**: Can you own something and not take care of it? Why does someone do that? Laziness, taking it for granted? No time? Allah never has any of these issues. Allah cares. He is Ar-Rahman and Ar-Raheem, so not only is he the most perfect caretaker, he also cares more than anyone else while having access to us.
 - Rabb as **access**: Availability is the ultimate deterrent of difficulty. Example: in America we even say access is power. Allah is always available, that is what is meant by rabb. Allah does not have the weakness that other caretakers have of being unavailable.
- **Message of hope**: Rabb represents care, provision, and availability. Rabb in this ayah is a message of hope.
- **Analogy**: Just as a parent protects a child according to what is best, Allah's timing and protection are perfect. Your definition of being taken care of might be different. Example: The parent will say their child can't drink soda, that is them taking care of the child. But the child thinks they are being punished.
- **Allah's timing**: Would you give a child keys to a car? No. Allah's timing is perfect, sometimes you are not ready for the blessing. Allah wants to give

you the key when you are older. Or perhaps you were never even meant to drive.

- **Question to ask Ourselves:** How can I be a slave of Allah if I have never understood the meaning of rabb?

Ayah 2: مَلِكِ النَّاسِ

"The Sovereign of mankind."

- **Malik** emphasizes **exclusive ownership**; Allah is the ultimate Master.
- Focus on humans (Nas) because people often seek refuge from **other humans**, highlighting human capacity for harm.
- **Shaytan-like qualities in humans:** planting thoughts, enabling their growth, creating subtle influence.
- **Lessons:**
 - Avoid exposing sins even in dua, as normalizing sin weakens us.
 - Sins of the heart (envy, arrogance, waswas, backbiting) are serious and require environmental and spiritual measures to combat.

Ayah 3: إِلَهِ النَّاسِ

"The God of mankind."

- **Ila:** has two meanings.
 - First meaning is "the one you turn towards"
 - Second meaning is "to be worshipped" (derivative of "aliha" which has a similar meaning)
- The nahw of ila: is Allah a derived name or an original name?
 - Allah is an original name but the letter allow for a spectrum of how Allah can be conveyed. The word Allah can have derivatives which are not original.
 - "Ila" is one of those derivatives
 - Allah will point to himself while switching the letters, and keeping meaning.
 - Even the pronoun is referring to him. Every letter in the name allah has meaning, in any context.
- What if people don't worship Allah? He is still their rabb, their malik
- There's no atheist on a sinking ship or a turbulent plane. Every person has tried to rely on Allah at some point in their life. That split moment of worship

Ayah 4: مِنَ الشَّرِّ الْوَسْوَاسِ الْخَنَّاسِ

"From the evil of the retreating whisperer."

- **Shar** (spark of fire) – Shaytan exploits moments of vulnerability.
- **Waswas**: thoughts or whispers, both positive and negative; here refers to **negative whispers**.
- **Khannas**: the retreating whisperer; Shaytan retreats only to return and erode spiritually over time.
- Story: Imam Malik on his deathbed repeatedly saying “Not yet” – even at the end of life, spiritual vigilance remains necessary.
- **Key lesson**: Motivation and tawfiq (divine facilitation) can leave us; perseverance in doing good is crucial.

الَّذِي يُوسَّوْسُ فِي صُدُورِ النَّاسِ: Ayah 5

“Who whispers [evil] into the chests of mankind.”

- **Sadr**: outermost layer of the heart; **Fu’ad**: deepest, most intimate layer.
- Shaytan enters only if allowed; recitation of protective duas strengthens the heart.
- Prophet ﷺ regularly recited: *Ya Muqalibal Qulub, Thabbit Qalbi...*
- Shaytan beautifies actions to deceive ego; we must guard access to our hearts.
- Protection benefits **ourselves and others**, preventing harm to both.

مِنَ الْجِنَّةِ وَالنَّاسِ: Ayah 6

“From among the jinn and mankind.”

- Includes humans because people are often the clearest source of opposition to Prophets.
- Guidance: balance interaction—**isolate, insulate, or integrate** as necessary.
- Protective strategies include **awareness, masking actions for piety, and giving dawah responsibly**.
- **Two key qualities for spiritual safety**:
 - **Ikhlas** (sincerity)
 - **Istikama** (steadfastness)

Key Lessons / Reflections

- Surah An-Nas emphasizes **internal protection** from whispers and evil influences.
- Allah is our **Rabb, Malik, and Ilah**—a comprehensive source of care, authority, and guidance.

- Spiritual vigilance is ongoing: even the elderly and experienced can be targeted by Shaytan.
- Protection involves:
 - **Spiritual routines** (wird)
 - **Identifying sources of waswas**
 - **Seeking specialized ruqya**
 - **Developing resilience and stubbornness in faith**
- Psychological reassurance: when the soul feels safe in Allah's care, external pressures and self-doubt have diminished effect.

Selected Vocabulary

- **I seek refuge** – أَعُوذُ – A'oodhu
- **Lord** – رَبِّ – Rabb
- **Owner / Sovereign** – مَلِك – Malik
- **God** – إِلَهِ – Ilah
- **Whisperer** – وَسْوَاس – Waswas
- **Retreating** – خَتَّاس – Khannas
- **Chest / Heart** – صُدُور – Sudur

Original notes:

- There are 2 surahs that the Prophet used to untie the knot of magic that was put on him.
- Surah Nas addresses internal issues a person may have.
- Allah emphasizes his own greatness because when someone is in a desperate state, they can only feel safe while being in the hands of someone who is capable of protecting them. Its reassurance of Allah's capacity as a protector

- This applies to self doubt as well, sometimes waswas can only be treated by knowing Allahs power is greater than our own deficiencies.
- If the soul and the heart feel safe, the outer circumstances will not bother you
-

Ayah 1

- Say I seek refuge in the lord of Mankind
- Qul meaning say, is to place emphasis. To show us this needs to be repeated regularly. This is the same pattern across the 4 Quls. Aoothu, see surah falaq
- Where does the word rabb come from?
- Murabbi means caretaker. Rabb is the first and last quality appearing in the Quran. It connotes ownership. Allah is our master and we are slave and it is a reminder we need because sometimes we get too comfortable.
- The next meaning of rabb is that he has clear access. Allegory, when you own something, if you can access it but you dont have full rights over it, do you really own it? Example of owning a house. You cant just add an extension whenever you want. You have ownership but you are not rabb.
- Rabb, meaning lordship, is a comfort. A person can feel so broken, but knowing that allahs access to us never changes. Same goes for when we are high.
- Tanzi means to pulls something from its roots. And in another surah Allah says tanzi-ul mulk, that he has complete access to pull something from its roots
- So rabb means ownership, and complete access.
- Now the meaning caretaker. Can you own something and not take care of it? Why does someone do that? Laziness, taking it for granted? No time?
- Allah never has any of these issues. Allah cares. He is Ar-Rahman and Ar-Raheem, so not only is he the most perfect caretaker, he also cares more than anyone else while having access to us.
- We have fear and we have hope. Rabb in this ayah is a message of hope.
- Your definition of being taken care of might be different. The parent will say their child cant drink soda, that is them taking care of the child. But the child thinks theyre being taken care.
- Would you give a child keys to a car? No. Allahs timing is perfect, sometimes you are not ready for the blessing. Allah wants to give you the key when you are older. Or perhaps you were never even meant to drive.
- How can I be a slave of Allah if I have never understood the meaning of rabb
- The last meaning of rabb is access
- Availability is the ultimate deterrent of difficulty. In America we even say access is power.
- Allah is always available, that is what is meant by rabb
- Allah doesnt have the weakness that other caretakers have

Ayah 2

- Malikinnas
- Malik exclusively means owner. In Fatiha allah also uses malik. Rabb can be misunderstood because it is broader. But malik is to make clear that allah does own us.
- Why does allah only use Nas? Allah is claiming ownership over just humans, because most often humans are seeking refuge in Allah from other humans
- Human beings are capable of great evil:
- What are shaytan-like qualities in human beings? There are many, but one of them is that humans know how to plant thought, and they are also good at letting them grow on their own. Shaytan on the DOJ will watch and say I didn't make you do it I just gave you the thought
- Lesson: Informing someone else of an evil is equivalent to doing it. We should be careful to not even mention our sins in dua or istighfar. The Prophets did not mention their sins when asking for forgiveness, they merely admitted their own deficiency and asked for forgiveness
- Why is being in the presence of sin harmful? It normalizes it for us. Do not go near it, in your environments, in your actions or even in your thoughts particularly in regards to repentance. It can lead to enjoying the sin while asking for forgiveness.
- All shaytan like symptoms are the greatest sins in our deen.
- Maida sins and shaytan sins. Sins of the body vs sins of the heart.
- Examples: hasad (envy), kibr (arrogance), waswas (planting seeds in other peoples minds), gheeba (backbiting)
- The best way to treat diseases of the heart is changing the environment

Ayah 3

- Ila hinnas
- What does iLA mean?
- Is allah a derived name or an original name? Nahw topic
- They differ, but conclude that Allah is an original name but the spectrum of Allahs name is wide and it can have derivatives which are not original
- Ila would be one of those derivatives
- Allah starts and ends with asking to be guided to his path.
- So what does ila mean?
- One meaning is someone **that you turn towards.**
- Another meaning is **to be worshipped.** It is attached to aliha which carries similar meaning.
- Allah will point to himself while switching the letters, and keeping meaning
- Even the pronoun is referring to him. Every letter in the name allah has meaning, in any context.

- What if people don't worship Allah? He is still their Rabb, their Malik
- There's no atheist on a sinking ship or a turbulent plane. Every person has tried to rely on Allah at some point in their life. That split moment of worship is still worship.

Ayahs 1-3 are

Ayah 4

Min sharril waswasil khannas

- Shar from sharara meaning fire. A spark of fire that touches you at a vulnerable moment.
- Shaytan takes advantage of small moments of vulnerability.
- We are asking Allah for protection from the smallest spark. This also alludes to how Shaytan will not show us the full picture of the evil awaiting us
- Waswas can mean thoughts, whispers, or negative of both
- Two thoughts that are positive and two that are negative
- How do we distinguish from alham (positive thought)? Hence Ilham as a name
- You can't process them in the same way.
- Wahi is another way to speak about positive thoughts.
- Ilham and wahi = positive/Allah
- Waswas and hamaza = negative/Shaytan
- Khannas means retreating. Why does Allah use it? Hint: shaytan runs away from athan.
- If someone reaches the age of 40 and they have certain habits, shaytan kisses them on the forehead and determines that he does not need to work on him
- Khannas mean retreating because Shaytan is playing the long game, he's looking for long term gains. He retreats in order to repeat. He wants to return over and over. Shaytan doesn't take losses and walk away, he comes back in different ways. Shaytan essentially markets to us, he knows our algorithms, he knows what is tempting to us.
- Shaytan is waswasil khannas, the retreating whisperer, because he retreats and returns. His goal is to slowly erode away at us.
- Remember this story under this ayah: Imam Malik was on his death bed and kept saying "Not yet". His son Salih asked why he kept saying "Not yet?". Iblis has come in the form of an elderly person and says "You got away from me, from all my tricks" and he's responding not yet because shaytan can still reach him.
- The lesson here is that tawfiq can still leave us even in death.
- The importance of keeping motivation to do good
- Hadith: What are the signs of me being a believer? Dear brother, when the good that you do makes you feel good.
- Feeling of imaan is the highlight because the prophet knew he's not asking about literal signs.

- Example of medical students: always complaining when they're in school. Why don't they leave? The first paycheck will make everything worth it.
- Struggling to pray for 20 years and enjoyed prayer for another 20. The struggle is worth it.
- It's possible that the good we're doing is not feeling good for us. A rich man giving 10 dollars won't feel it. Not feeling good out of wanting to do more is a good sign, but not wanting to do good period is not.

Ayah 5

- Allathee yu waswisu fi sudurinnas
- Qalb is heart but fu'ad is the deepest layer in the heart, where only you know what you are thinking about. And sadr, as used in this ayah is the outermost layer
- Sadr: the outer layer of the heart. Shaytan finds an opening to go in (fi) to the outer part of the heart.
- The Prophet recited this dua everyday: Ya muqalibal qulub, thabit qalbi...
- Ya allah keep my heart firm on the deen
- The only way shaytan can come in is if you let him in
- Sudur shows us we have some control over his access to our hearts
- Shaytan knocks and knocks until you give him a chance to break in
- Why would I want to get rid of shaytan when he's appeasing my ego
- Zayyini shaytanu: shaytan beautifies actions for us
- How do non believers think these are beautiful actions? Shaytan makes it feel like that. So sadr, we let shaytan in
- Imam Ghazali says, the things we recite are not only to protect ourselves from harm but also to protect other people from us. Shaytan can make us do things to harm people.
- A virus can only attack when your immune system is weak.

Ayah 6

Minnal jinnati wannas

- Sometimes your greatest influence is the people who are closest to you. Sometimes you have to isolate, other times you have to insulate, other times integrate
- Be with other people, be aware of what's happening around us, but mask it
- Mask is doing sunnah. Mask is wearing a palestinian bracelet. Masks are good friends. You keep a mask for your piety.
- Sometimes we have to integrate to give dawah. You are exposed to the difficulties of the world, without struggling
- We ask allah to protect us from the jinns and humans

Two most important alifs in your life

1. Ikhlas

2. Istikama

You'll find if you have one then you have both

Recommendations for treating extreme waswas:

Start a consistent wird (spiritual routine)

Find the source of the waswas

Find a specialist in ruqya (founded in hadith)

Learn how to be stubborn